The Mountainside

Published By the Coolfont Mountainside Association

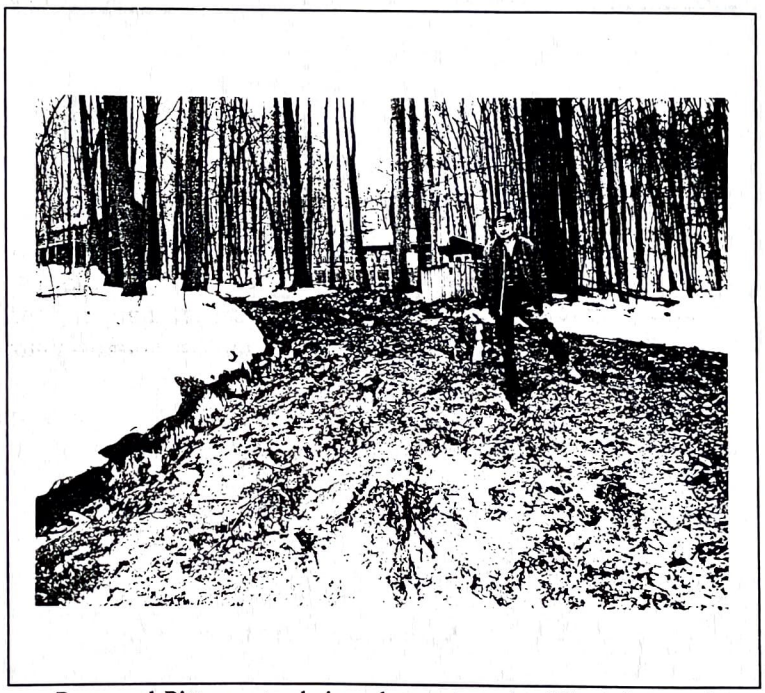
Volume 4, Issue No. 4 April, 1996

CMA and the Winter of '96

Members to Vote on Budget Transfer to Cover Damage

One of the hardest winters in recent years caused some tough challenges on the mountainside this year, but the repairs to damage have been completed, and the Spring promises a new start on our water -sewer upgrade project and other community improvement work.

The repeated heavy snows required far more snow removal than had been predicted or for which funds had been budgeted. But the worst damage was caused by the melting of those snows, most in one night of heavy rains, that washed out roads all over the mountainside. Alice Minnamon and Dwain Place identified many places where water rushing down the mountain washed the roads through, and which required immediate repairs to even become passable. Driveways to some homes were also totally severed by the heavy runoff, with some cuts as deep as three feet.



Raymond Pittman stands in a deep rut on the "J" section road following the flooding and washouts throughout CMA

The CMA board voted to ask the membership for approval to move $12,000 from the Administration section of the budget to Maintenence, to cover the overruns. A ballot to approve that transfer (required by CMA by laws) accompanies this newsletter.

REMINDER:
ANNUAL MEETING - NEW DATE: JULY 27!

CMA's Annual member meeting will be held at Coolfont on Saturday, July 27 this year, and all members should mark their calendars accordingly.

WINTER WEATHER DELAYS WATER UPGRADE WORK

The heavy snows also stopped CDC's work on the new "T" section road, which subsequently prevented the start of CMA's work on the construction road to the new CMA water storage site, high on the mountainside.

Lee Weinberger, chair of the Utilities Committee which, among other duties, oversees the upgrade construction, said the work will begin as soon as the "T" section road is made passable. Once that process begins, the new system is expected to be completed within a matter of months.

MEMBER LOANS FOR UPGRADE STILL NEEDED

The delay in the start of construction for the water sewere upgrade may have some mountainside members confused about the need for the money they pledged to loan CMA for the work. Bob Dowling, finance committee chair, reminds all "pledgers" that their loans are still needed, and if you have not been notified to send in your loan, you will be soon. Even members who are selling their houses are encouraged to make their loans to CMA because 1) it's good business, at a highly competitive interest rate, and 2) CMA really needs your help.

Bob also says that there is still a limited number of opportunities for other CMA members to make loans of $5,000 or more, with a return at 8%.

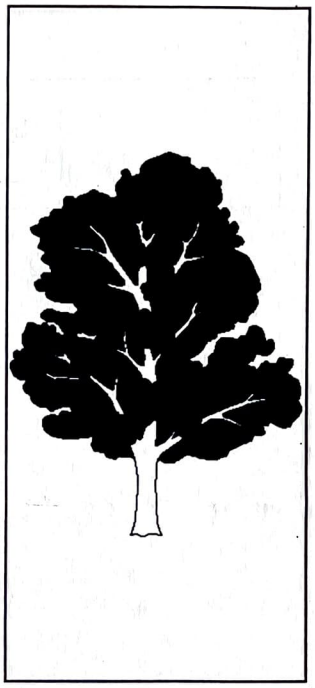
WHO'S ON THE 'NET? WHO'S MOVED?

The 1996 CMA Membership Directory is being prepared. If you have new telephone numbers, addresses, (or you want to include your fancy new Internet e-mail address) please send them in writing (FAX # (703) 549-9601 to Jackson Bain before April 30.

DO YOU HAVE ANY ITEMS FOR THE NEWSLETTER?

Send them to:

Jackson Bain
913 King Street
Alexandria, VA 22314



VOLUNTEERS NEEDED!

by Carrol Yingling
CMA Vice President

Your skills and interests can contribute to the life and vitality of CMA. Look over the list below and check the area where you would like to help. If you have a skill not listed, add it to the list. Tear it off and mail to me at the address below. Thanks for your help.

Accounting and budget
Arts and culture liaison
Landscape & gardening
Nature study
Planning social events
Property Maintenence
Trail marking and maintenence
Water meter reading
Other_____

Send to:
Carroll Yingling, Jr.
20 Cedarwood Road
Baltimore, MD 21228-2301